

• THE PLAYBOOK

AI-FUNDAMENT

Set up Claude. Understand it. Automate.

The direct path from "I installed Claude" to your first running automation — no jargon, no 40-page novel. Built for reference, not for reading cover to cover.

FOR
Professionals & young agencies

DURATION
One afternoon, step by step

V1 · 2026

• FIRST PAGE, PLEASE READ

How to use this PDF

01**Not front to back**

Jump straight to the module you need right now. Every page works on its own.

02**Cards, not walls of text**

Everything's broken into blocks. If a card is clear, move on — no mandatory reading.

03**Gold = action**

Gold-marked terms and boxes are links or the next concrete step.

PART 1 — UNDERSTAND

03	The Claude Map	03
04	Module 1 — Claude Basics	04
05	Module 2 — The Brain	05
06	Module 3 — Skills	06
07	Module 4 — Artifacts	07

PART 2 — CONNECT

08	Module 5 — Connecting Tools (MCP)	08
09	Module 6 — Automation Tools	09
10	Your First Automation	10

PART 3 — EXECUTE

11	The 7-Day Roadmap	11
12	The Toolbox — All Links	12
13	Prompt Building Blocks to Copy	13
14	Troubleshooting	14
15	The Cheat Sheet	15

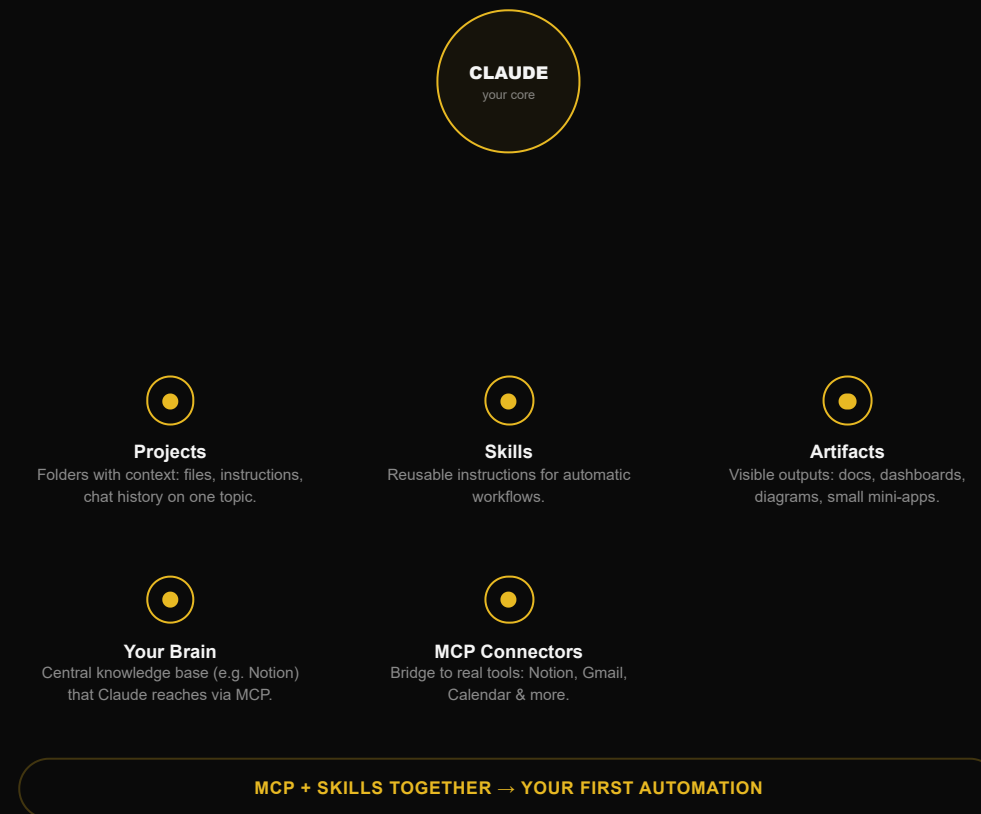
PART 4

16	And if you don't want to go it alone	16
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• THE MAP

Five building blocks, one system

Before we get to tools: here's how the pieces connect. Each term gets its own module on the following pages.



MODULE 1 CLAUDE BASICS

Before you automate anything

Claude isn't a chat window that forgets everything each time — if you set it up right. Three habits decide whether it feels like an intern with no memory or a team member.

01**One project per context**

Set up a dedicated project for each recurring area (e.g. "client inquiries," "content"). All related files & rules live there — Claude doesn't need anything explained twice.

02**Context before command**

Not "write an email," but: who's the recipient, what's the goal, what tone. Claude doesn't guess — it works with what you give it.

03**Iterate, don't perfect**

Rough first draft, then refine in 2–3 follow-ups ("shorter," "more direct," "drop point 3"). Faster than one perfect first prompt.

How to build a prompt that works

01**Goal**

What should come out at the end — concrete, not "something good."

02**Context**

For whom, for what, what info does Claude need that it can't guess.

03**Format**

List, table, plain text, length — say it instead of hoping.

04**Example**

One reference example beats any description, however long.

→ claude.ai/projects · docs.claude.com/prompting

MODULE 2 THE BRAIN

Claude forgets nothing when it has something to look up

The "Brain" isn't new software — it's a place (usually Notion) that holds everything Claude should know about you, your clients, and your processes. Claude reads it live instead of guessing.



Set up your Brain — in 4 steps

- ☐ **Create a Notion database**
One place for positioning, pricing, FAQs, processes — everything you'd otherwise explain to every new hire.
- ☐ **Connect Notion to Claude**
Via the Notion MCP connector (Settings → Connectors). Set up once, stays connected.
- ☐ **Structure over completeness**
Five clear pages (positioning, pricing, FAQ, processes, tone) beat 50 unsorted notes.
- ☐ **Test Claude: "What do you know about ...?"**
If the answer's right, the connection works. If not — usually just a heading in Notion needs to be clearer.

MODULE 3 SKILLS

Explain it once. Claude does it automatically from now on.

A Skill is a small set of instructions you write once — Claude reads it automatically whenever a matching task comes in. No more repeating "like last time" in every chat.

What a Skill looks like at its core

```
# SKILL.md
name: Invoice Check
description: Checks invoices for required fields
---
When an invoice is uploaded:
1. Check VAT number, date, amount
2. Compare with template in /Templates
3. Report missing fields as a list
```

In short: name, description (when does it fire?), instructions.
Claude recognizes on its own when a Skill fits the task.

Three Skills that pay off immediately

Brand-tone Skill**Content****Weekly report****Reporting****Proposal generator****Sales**

Start with whatever you've done manually for the third time this week — that's your first Skill.

When is a Skill worth it?

For anything you keep explaining the same way:
formatting rules, checklists, your brand tone, standard answers to client questions.

When is a normal chat enough?

For one-off tasks, or when the requirements shift a lot each time — a rigid Skill slows you down there.

MODULE 4 ARTIFACTS

When the answer needs to be more than text

An artifact is anything Claude builds for you that goes beyond plain chat text — it shows up as its own window you can use directly.

DASHBOARD**Interactive overview**

E.g. a client or project overview with filters — usable right away, no Excel needed.

PROTOTYPE**Landing page or mini-tool**

A clickable draft you can show directly or use as the basis for the real build.

DIAGRAM**Make processes visible**

Flowcharts, roadmaps, mindmaps — like the graphics in this PDF, generated straight from a description.

DOCUMENT**Fully formatted**

Reports, proposals, guides — as a standalone file instead of a chat message to copy out.

Rule of thumb: Text stays in the chat. Anything meant to stand alone and be reused becomes an artifact.

MODULE 5 CONNECTING TOOLS

MCP is the USB-C port for Claude

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is the open standard Claude uses to connect to your real tools — instead of you copy-pasting, Claude reads and writes directly where you already work.

The most common connectors

Notion — your Brain

Gmail — read & draft emails

Google Calendar — appointments

Google Drive — files

Slack — team communication

Zapier / Make — automation

How to set up a connector

In Claude: Settings → Connectors → pick a tool → confirm access. Two minutes, no coding required.

Security rule of thumb

Only grant access to tools you'll actually use — and double-check before confirming sensitive actions (sending email, deleting data).

→ claude.ai/settings/connectors · modelcontextprotocol.io

MODULE 6 AUTOMATION TOOLS

Which tool builds your automation?

Claude provides the intelligence (understanding, drafting, deciding). These three tools provide the connective tissue — they trigger, move data, and keep running in the background when you're not at your desk.

TOOL	BEST FOR	STRENGTH	GETTING STARTED
Zapier	Beginners, simple linear flows	Huge range of tool connections, "AI by Zapier" uses Claude with no API key of your own	Very easy — no code
Make	Multi-step workflows with branching	Visual editor, more control over logic & conditions than Zapier	Easy, some ramp-up
n8n	Technical users, complex/custom logic	Self-hosted or cloud, full control, direct Claude API connection	Medium — basic knowledge helps

Which tool for you?

Want to start today

Zapier. Ready-made "Zaps" for the most common cases (form → email, form → CRM) are live in minutes.

Need branching

Make. If your flow needs "if X then Y else Z," the visual editor is clearer.

Want full control

n8n. More setup effort, but no limits — and Claude can help you build the workflows directly.

• CONCRETE EXAMPLE

Your first automation, rebuildable today

A request comes in through your website form — and lands, summarized and sorted, automatically in your CRM. No more manual copying.



How to build this (Zapier example)

01

Set up the trigger

Connect a form tool (e.g. Tally, Typeform) to Zapier: "new response" as the trigger.

02

Add the Claude step

Choose the "AI by Zapier" action, prompt: "Summarize this request in 2 sentences and assign a category."

03

Set the destination step

Write the result into a Notion database, and send a Slack message to the team in parallel.

04

Check with a test entry

Fill out the form yourself once — see if everything arrives before customers do it.

• THE ROADMAP

7 days from zero to a running automation

Not a marathon weekend. Each day takes 20–40 minutes. Keep the order — every step builds on the last.

- 1 Foundation**
Set up Claude, create your first project (e.g. "My Business"). Add a short description of you, your offer, and your target audience.

- 2 Brain skeleton**
Create 5 pages in Notion: positioning, pricing, FAQ, processes, tone. Good enough for now — doesn't need to be complete.

- 3 Connect**
Activate the Notion connector in Claude (Modules 2 & 5). Check with a test question whether Claude can access your Notion content.

- 4 Write your first Skill**
Take the task you've repeated most this week — turn it into a Skill (Module 3).

- 5 Choose an automation tool**
Set up a Zapier account (or Make/n8n, see Module 6). Build a simple Zap without Claude to understand the tool.

- 6 Add Claude**
Insert the Claude step into the Zap (Module 6). Check with 2–3 test runs and sharpen the prompt.

- 7 Go live & watch**
Switch the automation on. Let it run for a week, then adjust once — don't perfect it beforehand.

• FOR REFERENCE

The Toolbox

Every link you need from this PDF — in one place.

Claude & Documentation

[Open Claude](#)[claude.ai](#)[Projects](#)[claude.ai/projects](#)[Set up connectors](#)[claude.ai/settings](#)[Prompting guide](#)[docs.claude.com](#)[What are artifacts?](#)[support.anthropic.com](#)

Your Brain

[Notion \(free\)](#)[notion.so](#)

Automation

[Zapier](#)[zapier.com](#)[Make](#)[make.com](#)[n8n](#)[n8n.io](#)

Keep Learning

[Understand MCP](#)[modelcontextprotocol.io](#)[MCP — Anthropic article](#)[anthropic.com/news](#)

Tip: Use this page as a bookmark substitute — one screenshot keeps every link within reach.

• COPY & PASTE

Prompt Building Blocks

Six prompts, ready to use. Replace the brackets with your own details.

TEST THE BRAIN

"What do you know about [topic/client], based on my Notion?"

CREATE A SKILL

"Create a Skill for [recurring task]. Ask me first what you need to know for it."

AUTOMATION STEP

"Summarize this request in 2 sentences and assign a category: Urgent / Normal / Spam."

BRAND-TONE CHECK

"Check this text against my brand tone in [Brain page] and suggest concrete adjustments."

WEEKLY REPORT

"Summarize the week: what happened, what worked, what didn't, next steps."

DOCUMENT A PROCESS

"I'll describe a process to you. Turn it into a step-by-step checklist for Notion."

Rule of thumb for your own prompts: Goal + Context + Format + Example (see Module 1, page 4).

- WHEN SOMETHING'S STUCK

Troubleshooting

The five stumbling blocks almost everyone hits — and the fix in one sentence.

01 Claude doesn't know my Notion content?

Check connector status (Settings → Connectors → green?). Usually helps: give Notion page titles clearer names instead of "Untitled" or generic labels.

02 The Skill doesn't trigger automatically?

The Skill's description is too vague. Claude decides based on the description when a Skill fits — the more specific, the more reliably it fires.

03 The Zap breaks mid-flow?

Usually a data-format mismatch between steps. Check the Zap log ("Task History") to see which step fails, and check the expected format there.

04 Claude's answers feel generic?

Not enough context given, or the Brain isn't connected. Back to Module 1: goal, context, format, example — in that order.

05 The automation runs, but the result is wrong?

The prompt in the automation step is too open-ended. Add a concrete example to the prompt — that sharpens the output almost every time.

• THE ONE PAGE THAT MATTERS

The Cheat Sheet

Keep this page open while you work. Everything else in this PDF leads back here.

What do I need right now?

SITUATION	USE THIS
Recurring context on one topic/client	Project
You keep explaining the same process to Claude	Skill
You need a visible result (doc, dashboard, diagram)	Artifact
Claude should read or describe real tools (Notion, mail, calendar)	MCP connector
The flow should run automatically, even without you at your desk	Zapier / Make / n8n + Claude

Five rules that carry everything else

01

Goal > Context > Format >
Example — in every prompt.

02

One project per recurring topic,
never everything in one chat.

03

The Brain is the source of truth —
not your memory.

04

Only automate what you've already
done by hand three times.

05

Go live, watch, adjust — don't
perfect it beforehand.

+

Stuck? Page 14
(Troubleshooting) or page 16.

- TO CLOSE

You don't have to do this alone.

This PDF gets you from zero to your first running automation. If you'd rather have someone set up the whole foundation — website, Brain, automation — for your business afterward: that's what we do at Reich Studio.

STARTER — AI-FUNDAMENT

Website, first automation, strategy call

AI-built website (up to 6 pages), 1 automation tailored to your needs, 60-min strategy call — one-time, from CHF 2'800.

→ **Book a first call:** reichstudio.ch/kontakt